

component of ITC's broader leisure expansion rather than a separate business vertical. "Our asset-right approach, with a strong emphasis on management contracts and partnerships, is particularly relevant here and more so in Tier-II and Tier-III destinations," he says.

The approach is part of a larger expansion strategy. ITC Hotels currently has a pipeline of 69 hotels with over 7,100 rooms and aims to reach 250 operational hotels with more than 22,000 rooms over the next five years. Wildlife destinations will form a selective but increasingly important part of that growth.

Other large chains are following suit.

At The Tamara Coorg, nearly 70% of guests participate in at least one guided plantation or forest trail